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Aadhaar-Enabled BIOMETRIC ATTENDANCE SYSTEM



Aadhaar-enabled UID kit (Image source: <http://www.uid-aadhaar.com>)

➤ Government buildings need multiple Aadhaar-enabled biometric attendance systems at their entry gates

The market for Aadhaar-enabled devices is about ₹ 2.5 billion. The opportunity to cater to new as well as replacement systems is tremendous. While we as a nation contemplate opportunities for Aadhaar, global leaders like Satya Nadella are quite optimistic and excited about the possibilities that it will enable.

In his book *Hit Refresh*, Nadella mentioned, "Aadhaar now has scaled to over one billion people, rivaling the growth of other platform innovations such as Windows, Android or Facebook." He praised creation of the new digital ecosystem IndiaStack. IndiaStack is a set of application programming interfaces (APIs) that allows governments, businesses, startups and developers to utilise a unique digital Infrastructure to solve India's problems of presence-

less, paperless and cashless services delivery.

Recently, central government has mandated all government institutions to adhere to Aadhaar-enabled biometric attendance system (AEBAS). The main intent behind the move is to increase productivity of employees. The system authenticates attendance using Aadhaar number created by Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI).

Business opportunity

Till date, only 10 per cent government organisations have started marking attendance on AEBAS. Most government organisations look forward to inviting bid proposals and choose the best suited option for AEBAS. They are looking for reliable vendors to provide a complete solution for enforcement.

Presently, various companies are offering Aadhaar kits, but there is still a huge potential for new players to join the course. Matrix offers Cospec Vega Faxq, which is designed for Aadhaar-enabled attendance marking. It is perhaps the only embedded Linux-based attendance device available in the Indian market as of now. The system user can directly show RFID card, that is Mifare Smart, and provide fingerprint.

Benefits of a cloud-based attendance system

The Indian government has decided to go for a robust and centralised attendance management system that offers easy access, easy scalability and uniformity in architecture while costing less.

To avail these benefits, the concerned government organisation will have to register with the AEBAS server. Employees' attendance on AEBAS server will be linked with UIDAI server. Attendance will be taken using the user's unique Aadhaar number and biometric credentials.

Authentication process. Companies like Braintech Services provide iris and fingerprint scanners as part of their UID kit. Ravish, managing director of Braintech Services, shares, "Being a provider of biometric attendance solutions, we foresee AEBAS to emerge as the biggest opportunity in the segment ever. All government organisations are adopting the system as they are getting the required infrastructure as soon as they get clearance from the concerned nodal officer."